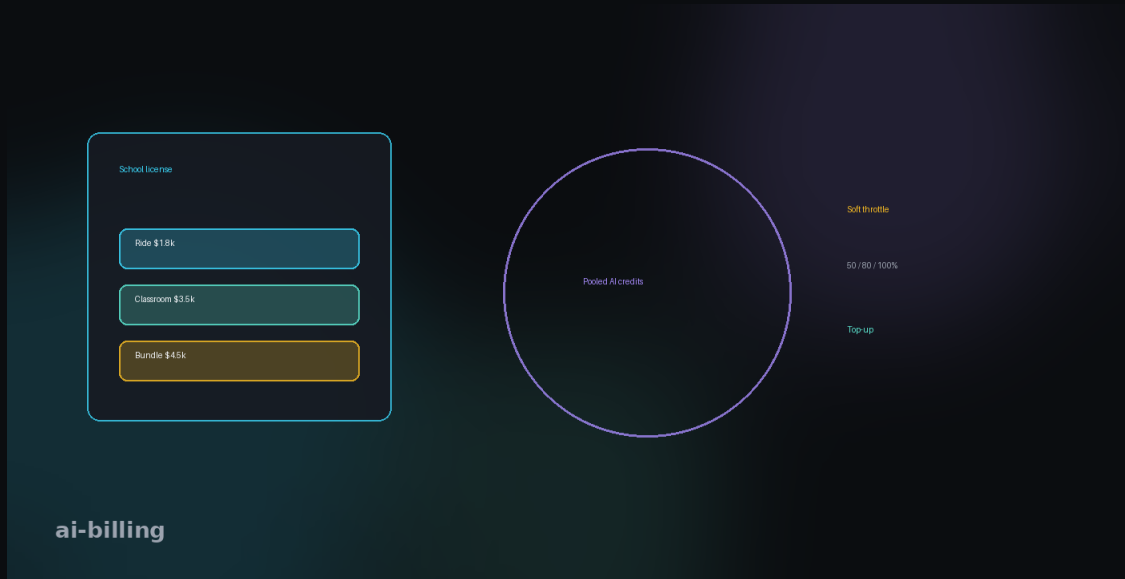




# AI Credits / Billing — Research Digest

Dark visual edition • 2026-09-24

Card t\_7b962b91 • BILLING • Research digest (no app implementation)

**Chuck Broaddus / Kelyra • Confidential**

Source: dated research digests under notes/company • graphics illustrate locked recommendations.

## Executive recommendation

### Locked recommendation

Hybrid: school site license (Ride / Classroom / Bundle) + pooled school AI credits metered at Edge + soft throttle (50/80/100%) + prepaid top-up / Stripe overage. Buyer is the school — teachers never need a personal card. First-party ledger before Metronome.

## Decision cards

|                                       |                                 |
|---------------------------------------|---------------------------------|
| <b>Model</b><br><br>Hybrid            | <b>Buyer</b><br><br>School site |
| <b>Throttle</b><br><br>Soft 50/80/100 | <b>Cash</b><br><br>Stripe + ACH |

### Hybrid model — school license + pooled credits + soft throttle

|                                             |                                                    |                                                      |
|---------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Feature tiers alone</b><br><br><b>No</b> | <b>Flat + throttle only</b><br><br><b>Trial OK</b> | <b>Hybrid (recommended)</b><br><br><b>Yes — lock</b> |
|---------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------|

Figure: Tiers vs flat vs hybrid pick.

# AI Credits / Billing — Research Digest

Date: 2026-09-24 Author: Chief of Staff / Grok Bot (Kelyra) Status: Ready for Chuck review SoT pair: [notes/company/ai-credits-billing-research.md](#) · [notes/company/ai-credits-billing-plan.md](#) Card: [t\\_7b962b91](#) Access date for all URLs: 2026-09-24 (America/Chicago)

This dated file is a readable pack for Chuck. Full detail lives in the SoT pair above. Research + recommendation only — no app implementation. No Hermes AI staffing.

Not legal/tax advice.

## Recommendation (pick)

Best model for school B2B: Hybrid

| Model                                                                          | Verdict                                                                            |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| AI feature tiers alone (Starter/Pro/Unlimited)                                 | No — confuses Ride/Classroom/Bundle; “Unlimited” burns Gemini                      |
| Flat fee + throttle only                                                       | Trial OK / enforcement layer — too punitive alone; leaves overage revenue on table |
| Hybrid = flat school license + pooled credits + soft throttle + overage/top-up | Yes — choose this                                                                  |

## Recommendation bullets

- Sell school site licenses (GTM: Ride \$1,800/yr, Classroom \$3,500/yr, Bundle \$4,500/yr) via Stripe invoice + ACH, outside App Store.
- Include a pooled school AI credit budget; meter at Edge (tokens → weighted credits).

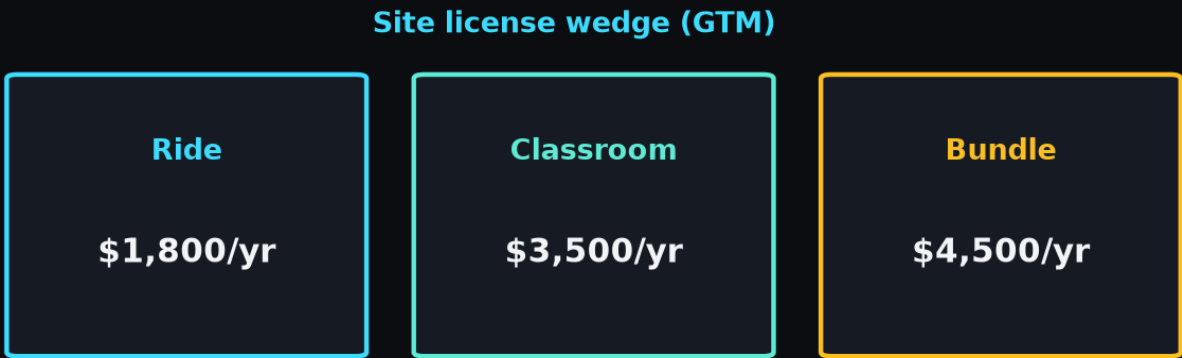


Figure: GTM site license wedge.

- Soft alerts at 50/80/100%; soft degrade before hard-stop; hard-stop only for unpaid/abuse/empty trial.
- Monetize excess with prepaid top-ups and/or Stripe metered overage — not raw token pass-through.
- Buyer = school; teachers never need a personal card to grade homework.
- Keep paid Gemini (Flash-Lite default) with project spend caps + Prepay auto-reload so vendor 402 does not strand classrooms.
- Do not ship Metronome for trial; first-party ledger first; Stripe mirrors cash.

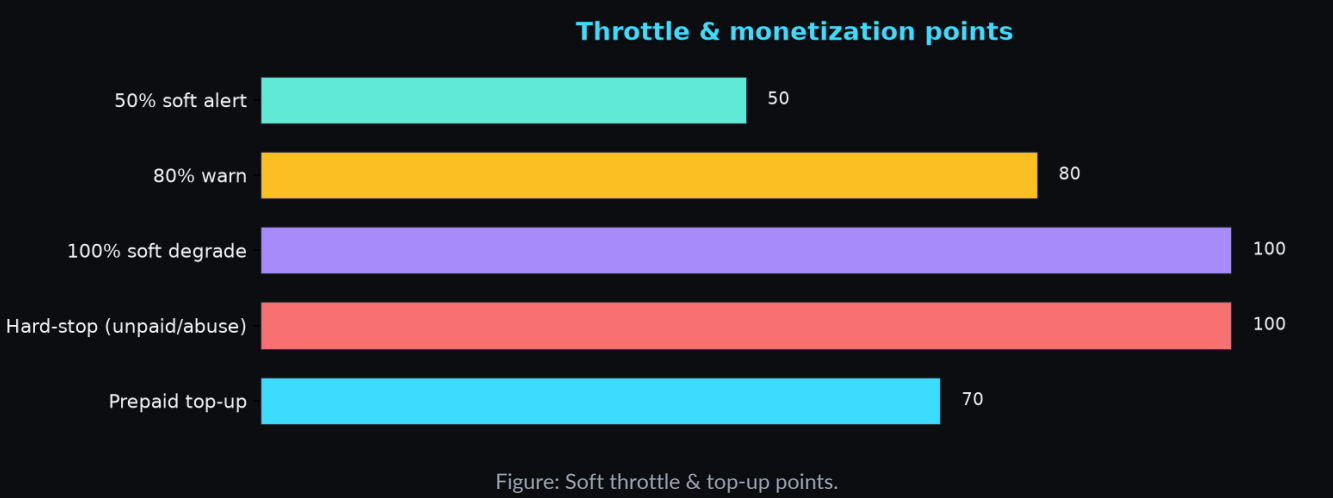
Why hybrid (one page)

Edtech peers package AI as institution or seat products with fair-use, not token invoices:

- MagicSchool: Free / Plus (~\$8.33/user/mo annual) / Enterprise custom — Plus markets unlimited gens; Enterprise adds oversight (magicschool.ai/pricing).
- Khanmigo / district AI: per-student annual add-ons in secondary 2026 summaries — still school-buyer.
- Copilot Edu: expensive per-seat productivity AI — wrong analogy for vision gradebook.

Stripe supports the hybrid cash path: licensed subscriptions + Billing Meters / Credit Grants, with Metronome recommended for heavy prepaid/real-time later (usage-based; credits; prorations; ACH invoices).

Gemini side: paid tiers, Prepay/Postpay (Prepay emphasis from ~2026-03-23), spend caps, Flash-Lite \$0.30 / \$2.50 per 1M in/out (billing; pricing).



GTM already sketched soft AI caps + overage; this card locks hybrid and specifies metering/UX/Stripe.

Coverage map

| Topic                            | Research \$       | Plan \$         |
|----------------------------------|-------------------|-----------------|
| Tiers vs flat+throttle vs hybrid | Research \$3      | Plan \$0        |
| Metering                         | Research \$4      | Plan \$4.1–4.2  |
| Stripe billing                   | Research \$5      | Plan \$4.3, \$5 |
| Upgrades                         | Research \$5.3    | Plan \$5        |
| Monitoring                       | Research \$6, \$8 | Plan \$6        |
| UX                               | Research \$7      | Plan \$4.4–4.5  |
| Work breakdown                   | —                 | Plan \$3–4      |
| Open questions                   | Research \$9      | Plan \$8        |

Phase snapshot

| Phase   | Ship                                                            |
|---------|-----------------------------------------------------------------|
| A Trial | Edge usage log, manual grant, Chuck Gemini alerts, soft banners |

| Phase          | Ship                                                                                |
|----------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| B Paid #1      | Stripe annual modules + ACH, mint credits on <code>invoice.paid</code> , office ... |
| C Multi-school | Meter/Metronome decision, self-serve top-up, margin digest                          |

Open questions for Chuck

- 1. Year-1: auto overage invoice vs prepaid packs only?
- 2. Credits from day one vs temporary “vision jobs” unit?



Figure: Trial → Paid → Multi-school.

- 3. Mid-year Bundle upgrade: prorate now vs next term?
- 4. Classroom vs Bundle: same AI pool or Bundle richer?
- 5. Teacher personal top-ups ever, or always school-pooled?
- 6. CPA: TX SaaS tax? Counsel: IAP still clear for web school licenses?

Key citations

| Topic                              | URL                                                                                                                                                               |
|------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Stripe usage-based / Metronome     | <a href="https://docs.stripe.com/billing/subscriptions/usage-based">https://docs.stripe.com/billing/subscriptions/usage-based</a>                                 |
| Stripe billing credits             | <a href="https://docs.stripe.com/billing/subscriptions/usage-based/billing-credits">https://docs.stripe.com/billing/subscriptions/usage-based/billing-credits</a> |
| Stripe prorations                  | <a href="https://docs.stripe.com/billing/subscriptions/prorations">https://docs.stripe.com/billing/subscriptions/prorations</a>                                   |
| Stripe ACH invoicing               | <a href="https://docs.stripe.com/invoicing/ach-direct-debit">https://docs.stripe.com/invoicing/ach-direct-debit</a>                                               |
| Gemini billing                     | <a href="https://ai.google.dev/gemini-api/docs/billing">https://ai.google.dev/gemini-api/docs/billing</a>                                                         |
| Gemini pricing                     | <a href="https://ai.google.dev/gemini-api/docs/pricing">https://ai.google.dev/gemini-api/docs/pricing</a>                                                         |
| MagicSchool pricing                | <a href="https://www.magicschool.ai/pricing">https://www.magicschool.ai/pricing</a>                                                                               |
| Kelyra GTM (modules + soft AI cap) | <a href="notes/research/2026-09-24-production-gtm-report.md">notes/research/2026-09-24-production-gtm-report.md</a>                                               |

Paths written

- `notes/company/ai-credits-billing-research.md`
- `notes/company/ai-credits-billing-plan.md`

